



An Open Letter to M.R. Rangaswami, Sanjeev Joshipura and the Indiaspora Family

I will forever thank God for what you have created, cultivated, and become as Indiaspora. While I know that some of you might not be of the same faith that I am, and fewer still considered by ethnicity to be a part of the African Diaspora, you have come together to create what I consider to be one of the most intentionally kind, selfless, loving and giving communities I have ever experienced. Simply stated, you have chosen to live out one of the highest spiritual principals, “to love thy neighbor as thyself” not simply with words but through actions. Your amassing of the ‘brain trust’ that you represent, not for self-aggrandizement but for purposeful engagement, meaningful impact and societal change is both unique and extraordinary.

It was an amazing privilege to join D.J. Patil and Vanita Gupta as a panelist on your Town Hall focused on Civil Rights Issues ranging from the Covid-19 crisis and its impact upon Black and poor communities and the senseless killing of George Floyd as we unknowingly stood on the front edge of the largest global civil rights revolution in history in response to Mr. Floyd’s sad, senseless and tortuous death. The worldwide response reminds us that a part of the ‘American Dream’ that is a nightmare for many peoples of color.

Through the relatively short time we spent on the call I was encouraged to believe in the goodness of God as expressed through Indiaspora as people who put their faith into action and are willing to share and collaborate to reach measurable goals thought by others to be unattainable. I am excited about the possibility of encouraging the replication of the ‘best practices’ that Indiaspora has inspired and spawned and is seeding throughout the country.

You, Indiaspora, are living proof that challenges any person or group who questions the value of not just cultural exchange but of the worth of a global culture now experienced in America and beyond through your acts of generosity to the ‘untouchable’ Black American community and others worldwide. Using your distinct and invaluable experiences, resources and influence, you have given new life and hope to the principles which a group of disheveled and beleaguered outcasts espoused when escaping the oppression of Europe before casting them aside upon meeting the vulnerable Native Americans who first possessed this land we call America. (in part because of their hospitality and kindness to the ‘Pilgrims’)

As this country and the world turns it back on Racial hatred and injustice that you have and are overcoming, let us fill our sails with the fresh breath of hope that Indiaspora breathes out. Let us together embrace your efforts to lift African Americans and others enslaved and impoverished by prejudice to the highest level of life achievement. Let us together find the true harmony of citizenship in America and the global community as a part of a world delivered from the tyranny of self-hate and social, economic and spiritual prejudice.

I pray and respectfully ask the privilege of sharing this journey to a healthier, stronger and greater America and world with you.

Gratefully and Prayerfully Yours,

Pastor Carl McCluster

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